



Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

UEN: 201200696W

LEARNER GUIDE

For

Customer-Centric Branding and Communication Tactics

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How to Use This Guide

This Learner Guide accompanies the WSQ course Customer-Centric Branding and Communication Tactics (TGS-2026061321), conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd. It supports the Skills Framework Technical Skill & Competency “Brand Management” (ICT-SNM-3002-1.1, Level 3) across 4 Learning Units and 17 in-class activities.

Use this guide alongside the course slides during class, and again during the open-book assessment. Each Learning Unit section below lists the key concepts, followed by every activity you will complete in class with its scenario, step-by-step instructions and a debrief prompt to check your own work. This is a workshop-based course rather than a software course, so activities are illustrated with worked templates and examples on the slides rather than software screenshots.

Before you start, you will need:

- A notebook or digital document to capture your activity work.
- Internet access to research live brand examples where an activity calls for one.
- The course slides (downloaded from the LMS) for reference during activities and the assessment.

Course Learning Outcomes

- LO1: Identify the internal and external stakeholders and audiences who influence the brand, and create branding designs and reputation assessments that reflect the organisation's product or service attributes and benefits.
- LO2: Capture and analyse customer insights through strategic active-listening approaches — understanding customer perceptions of the brand and documenting the reception and outcomes of branding campaigns.
- LO3: Apply branding fundamentals within the marketing mix — executing branding campaigns, events and public-relations activities that increase brand awareness in alignment with brand positioning strategy, operational plans and budget.
- LO4: Evaluate brand and public-relations effectiveness using reputation indicators and KPIs across platforms, and recommend improvements to strengthen public-relations campaign performance.

Skills Framework Reference

- TSC Title: Brand Management
- TSC Code: ICT-SNM-3002-1.1
- Proficiency Level: Level 3

LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation

Internal & External Stakeholders · Audience Types · Brand Design · Reputation Assessment

Key concepts

- Internal stakeholders (management, employees) and external stakeholders (customers, partners, investors, media) each hold a different level of influence over — and interest in — the brand.
- External audiences segment into customers, partners, investors and media; each needs its own communication approach and message.
- Branding designs and ideas should foreground the product or service's attributes and the concrete benefits they deliver to the audience.
- Assessing an organisation's reputation on social media and other platforms — reviews, mentions, sentiment — is the starting point for every branding decision.

Activity 1 — Stakeholder Influence Mapping

Objective: Identify internal and external stakeholders influencing the brand.

Scenario

Your company is launching a new sustainability initiative. Map internal and external stakeholders, assess their influence levels, and design engagement strategies for each group.

You'll produce

A stakeholder influence matrix (12 stakeholders) with an engagement strategy for each group (Duration: 25 minutes.)

Step-by-step

1. List 6 internal and 6 external stakeholders for the sustainability initiative.
2. Rate each stakeholder's influence on a 1–5 scale.
3. Identify each stakeholder's primary brand concern.
4. Design a specific communication approach for each group.

Debrief it

Check: Present a completed stakeholder influence matrix with an engagement strategy for every stakeholder — the trainer checks that internal and external groups are both represented and that each strategy matches the stakeholder's stated concern.

Activity 2 — Audience Mapping Workshop

Objective: Recognise the types of external audience and their needs.

Scenario

Your company is launching a new sustainability product line. Map external audiences and develop targeted messaging strategies for each segment.

You'll produce

An audience mapping matrix covering 4 external segments with tailored messaging and channels (Duration: 25 minutes.)

Step-by-step

5. Identify four primary external audience segments for the product.
6. Research the demographic and psychographic profile of each segment.
7. Create a tailored key message for each segment, emphasising the relevant benefit.
8. Select the appropriate communication channel(s) for each audience.
9. Present the audience mapping matrix with its messaging strategy.

Debrief it

Check: Present a comprehensive audience-analysis matrix with segment profiles and a customised communication plan per segment.

Activity 3 — Brand Attribute Mapping

Objective: Draft branding designs and ideas highlighting the product or service's attributes and benefits.

Scenario

Design a brand identity for a new fitness app targeting busy professionals, mapping both hard attributes (features) and soft attributes (lifestyle benefits) into a compelling visual concept.

You'll produce

A brand attribute map (3 hard + 3 soft attributes), a mood board and a logo concept (Duration: 30 minutes.)

Step-by-step

10. List 3 hard attributes and 3 soft attributes for the fitness app.
11. Create a visual mood board that represents the brand personality.
12. Design a logo concept that incorporates the key attributes.
13. Present a brand narrative that connects the features to the benefits.

Debrief it

Check: Present the complete brand attribute map alongside the visual concept, showing a clear line from each hard attribute to the soft benefit it supports.

Activity 4 — Digital Reputation Audit Exercise

Objective: Assess the organisation's reputation on social media and other platforms.

Scenario

Your organisation has received mixed customer feedback across social platforms. Conduct a reputation assessment to identify improvement opportunities and develop an action plan.

You'll produce

A reputation-assessment report covering 3 platforms with sentiment breakdown and an action plan (Duration: 45 minutes.)

Step-by-step

14. Select three platforms (e.g. Google, Facebook, one competitor platform).
15. Document 10 recent mentions/reviews per platform.
16. Categorise each piece of feedback as positive, neutral or negative.
17. Identify three recurring themes or issues across the feedback.
18. Develop a targeted response strategy for each theme.

Debrief it

Check: Present the reputation-assessment report — platform-by-platform analysis, an overall sentiment breakdown, the three key themes, and a strategic recommendation for each.

LU2 — Customer Influence

Customer Perceptions · Brand Reputation · Campaign Reception · Active Listening

Key concepts

- Customers form perceptions of a brand, its products and its services from quality, experience and communication — a gap often exists between what a company believes and what customers actually feel.
- Customers actively shape brand reputation through word-of-mouth, reviews and advocacy — their voice can amplify or damage a brand faster than any paid campaign.

- Documenting customer reception and the outcome of branding campaigns turns anecdotal feedback into evidence for future campaign decisions.
- Active listening — full attention, a structured framework, and paraphrasing without judgement — reveals the customer's true perspective of the organisation.

Activity 5 — Brand Perception Audit

Objective: Assess customer perceptions of the brand, products and services.

Scenario

Your company recently received mixed customer reviews. Management believes service quality is excellent, but customer-satisfaction scores are declining. Conduct a perception audit to identify the gaps.

You'll produce

A perception-gap analysis report comparing internal quality metrics with customer feedback (Duration: 25 minutes.)

Step-by-step

19. Survey 20 recent customers about their service experience.
20. Compare internal quality metrics with the customer feedback.
21. Identify the top 3 perception gaps.
22. Develop an action plan to address the gaps.

Debrief it

Check: Present the perception-gap analysis report with improvement recommendations for each of the top 3 gaps.

Activity 6 — Brand Advocacy Assessment

Objective: Recognise the importance of the customer in influencing brand reputation.

Scenario

Your company recently received mixed reviews online. As brand manager, analyse customer feedback and develop an advocacy strategy to improve brand reputation through existing satisfied customers.

You'll produce

A customer-advocacy strategy document with target impact metrics (Duration: 25 minutes.)

Step-by-step

23. Review the provided customer feedback data.
24. Identify satisfied customers for the advocacy programme.
25. Design an advocacy campaign that leverages their positive experiences.
26. Present the strategy together with its expected impact metrics.

Debrief it

Check: Present a comprehensive advocacy strategy document with named target metrics and how they will be tracked.

Activity 7 — Campaign Documentation Audit

Objective: Document customer reception to the brand and the outcome of branding campaigns.

Scenario

Your company launched a new product branding campaign three months ago. Management needs a documentation report on customer reception and campaign outcomes to inform future marketing investment.

You'll produce

A structured campaign-reception report with metrics, analysis and optimisation recommendations (Duration: 25 minutes.)

Step-by-step

27. Identify three key metrics from the campaign data.
28. Analyse customer feedback patterns and sentiment trends.
29. Create a documentation framework for ongoing measurement.
30. Present the findings with actionable recommendations.

Debrief it

Check: Present the structured campaign-reception report, including the documentation framework that will be reused for the next campaign.

Activity 8 — Customer Perspective Analysis

Objective: Perform active listening from the customer to understand the customer's perspective of the organisation.

Scenario

You receive a complaint from a long-term customer expressing frustration about recent service changes. They say they feel 'unheard' and 'unimportant' to your organisation.

You'll produce

A completed customer-perspective analysis report with actionable insights (Duration: 25 minutes.)

Step-by-step

31. Apply the 3 P's framework — Presence, Patience, Paraphrasing — during the conversation.
32. Identify the emotions behind the customer's specific words.
33. Paraphrase the customer's perspective back to them without judgement.
34. Document the insights for strategic decision-making.

Debrief it

Check: Present the completed customer-perspective analysis report — the trainer checks that the emotion behind the words (not just the words) is captured, and that the insight is actionable.

LU3 — Branding in Marketing

Branding Basics · Role in Marketing · Awareness Campaigns · PR Execution

Key concepts

- Branding basics — visual identity, brand values, brand voice and brand guidelines — give a business a consistent, recognisable presence.
- Branding plays a central role in marketing: it builds trust, differentiates from competitors and creates the emotional connection that drives loyalty.
- Executing branding campaigns, events and activities — from social pushes to experiential pop-ups — raises brand awareness across the target audience.
- Public-relations campaigns must align to the brand positioning strategy, the operational plan and the marketing budget to stay credible and sustainable.

Activity 9 — Brand Audit Workshop

Objective: Explain the basics of branding.

Scenario

You are consulting for a local restaurant with inconsistent branding across their website, social media, and physical location. The owner wants to understand how to create unified brand guidelines.

You'll produce

A brand-guidelines document — visual standards, voice guidelines and an implementation roadmap (Duration: 30 minutes.)

Step-by-step

35. Analyse the current brand touchpoints and identify inconsistencies.
36. Define the core brand values and a mission statement.
37. Create visual identity specifications — logo and colours.
38. Develop brand-voice guidelines for customer communication.
39. Design an implementation plan with specific application examples.

Debrief it

Check: Present the comprehensive brand-guidelines document — visual standards, voice guidelines, and the implementation roadmap.

Activity 10 — Brand-Marketing Audit Exercise

Objective: Explain the role of branding in marketing.

Scenario

You are a marketing manager evaluating how well your company's current marketing campaigns align with brand identity. Select a real company and analyse one of their recent marketing campaigns.

You'll produce

A brand-audit report with a consistency assessment and recommendations (Duration: 20 minutes.)

Step-by-step

40. Choose a brand and identify its core identity elements.
41. Analyse one recent marketing campaign for brand consistency.
42. Evaluate the alignment between the brand messaging and the campaign goals.
43. Identify gaps and propose improvements for better integration.

Debrief it

Check: Present the brand-audit report with a consistency assessment score and concrete recommendations.

Activity 11 — Brand Activation Planning Workshop

Objective: Execute branding campaigns, events and activities to increase brand awareness.

Scenario

Your organisation wants to launch a new product line and needs to increase brand awareness by 40% within 6 months. Design a multi-channel campaign that includes both digital and experiential elements.

You'll produce

A campaign-strategy document with timeline, budget allocation and success metrics (Duration: 30 minutes.)

Step-by-step

44. Define the target audience's demographics and psychographics.
45. Develop a core brand message aligned with the audience's values.
46. Select 3–4 marketing channels and design consistent visuals across them.
47. Plan one experiential event and its supporting digital content.
48. Create a measurement framework using brand-recall metrics.

Debrief it

Check: Present the complete campaign-strategy document with timeline, budget allocation and success metrics — the trainer checks the digital and experiential elements are both present and consistent.

Activity 12 — PR Campaign Budget Planning

Objective: Execute public-relations campaigns in alignment to brand positioning strategies, operational plans and budget.

Scenario

You're the marketing manager for a growth-stage tech company launching a new product. Create a PR campaign budget aligned with the brand positioning strategy.

You'll produce

A PR budget proposal with channel allocation and success metrics (Duration: 25 minutes.)

Step-by-step

49. Define three core content pillars for the brand.
50. Allocate 15% of the marketing budget to PR activities.
51. Distribute the PR budget across earned, owned and paid channels.
52. Identify the key performance indicators for measurement.

Debrief it

Check: Present the complete PR budget proposal — channel allocation and the KPIs used to judge success.

LU4 — Branding Effectiveness

Reputation Metrics · Success Indicators · PR Tactics · KPI Monitoring · Continuous Improvement

Key concepts

- Reputation is measured through social metrics, digital metrics (traffic, mentions) and business KPIs (NPS, satisfaction) across every platform the organisation touches.
- Successful branding shows up in awareness, customer loyalty, financial impact and trust metrics — tracked consistently over time, not measured once.
- Public-relations tactics — media relations, community outreach, crisis management and digital engagement — extend the brand's message beyond paid channels.
- Monitoring the brand against SMART KPIs and acting on the gaps turns brand management into a continuous-improvement cycle rather than a one-off campaign.

Activity 13 — Platform Reputation Audit

Objective: Identify measures or indicators of the organisation's reputation on different platforms.

Scenario

Your organisation needs to establish reputation monitoring for a new product launch across social media, review sites, and business platforms.

You'll produce

A reputation-monitoring framework with defined metrics and tracking systems
(Duration: 20 minutes.)

Step-by-step

53. Map the stakeholder groups and select 3 key platforms per group.
54. Define specific KPIs for the social, digital and business indicators.
55. Set up monitoring tools and establish baseline measurements.
56. Create a weekly reporting dashboard showing sentiment trends.

Debrief it

Check: Present the comprehensive reputation-monitoring framework with its metrics and tracking system.

Activity 14 — Brand Health Assessment

Objective: Recognise the indicators of successful branding.

Scenario

You are a marketing manager evaluating your company's brand performance using both traditional and digital metrics.

You'll produce

A brand-health scorecard with metric definitions, current performance and an improvement plan (Duration: 25 minutes.)

Step-by-step

57. Select 3 key metrics from the awareness, loyalty and performance categories.
58. Design a measurement approach that combines survey and digital analytics.
59. Create a monthly tracking dashboard with benchmarks.
60. Present the findings with actionable recommendations.

Debrief it

Check: Present the brand-health scorecard — metric definitions, current performance and the improvement plan.

Activity 15 — PR Crisis Response Plan

Objective: Apply public-relations tactics.

Scenario

Your company faces negative social-media coverage about product-quality issues. Design a comprehensive PR response strategy using the tactics learned.

You'll produce

A crisis-communication plan with timelines and responsible parties (Duration: 25 minutes.)

Step-by-step

61. Identify the affected stakeholder groups and media outlets.
62. Develop core messaging that addresses the concerns transparently.
63. Create a media-outreach plan with personalised pitches.
64. Design the social-media response and community-engagement plan.
65. Establish measurement metrics for reputation recovery.

Debrief it

Check: Present the complete crisis-communication plan with a timeline and the party responsible for each action.

Activity 16 — KPI Dashboard Design

Objective: Monitor the success of the brand against Key Performance Indicators (KPI).

Scenario

Create a brand KPI monitoring framework for a retail company launching new product lines.

You'll produce

A complete KPI framework with a tracking schedule (Duration: 20 minutes.)

Step-by-step

66. Select 3 internal and 3 external KPIs.
67. Define the measure, target, data source and frequency for each KPI.
68. Design a monthly tracking dashboard.

Debrief it

Check: Present the complete KPI framework with its tracking schedule — 3 internal + 3 external KPIs, each with a measure, target, source and frequency.

Activity 17 — PR Campaign Audit Exercise

Objective: Provide suggestions to improve public-relations campaign effectiveness.

Scenario

Your organisation's recent product-launch campaign achieved 500K impressions but only 15% top-tier coverage and 45% message penetration. Stakeholders are questioning the campaign's business impact.

You'll produce

An improvement proposal with metrics, built using the AMEC measurement framework (Duration: 25 minutes.)

Step-by-step

69. Apply the AMEC framework to identify the performance gaps.
70. Develop three strategic recommendations using best practice.
71. Create a measurement plan with specific KPIs.

Debrief it

Check: Present the comprehensive improvement proposal — the three recommendations must each map to a specific gap surfaced by the AMEC analysis.

Quick Reference — Activities by Learning Unit

Learning Unit	Activity	Duration
LU1	1. Stakeholder Influence Mapping	25 minutes
LU1	2. Audience Mapping Workshop	25 minutes
LU1	3. Brand Attribute Mapping	30 minutes
LU1	4. Digital Reputation Audit Exercise	45 minutes
LU2	5. Brand Perception Audit	25 minutes
LU2	6. Brand Advocacy Assessment	25 minutes
LU2	7. Campaign Documentation Audit	25 minutes
LU2	8. Customer Perspective Analysis	25 minutes
LU3	9. Brand Audit Workshop	30 minutes
LU3	10. Brand-Marketing Audit Exercise	20 minutes
LU3	11. Brand Activation Planning Workshop	30 minutes
LU3	12. PR Campaign Budget Planning	25 minutes
LU4	13. Platform Reputation Audit	20 minutes
LU4	14. Brand Health Assessment	25 minutes
LU4	15. PR Crisis Response Plan	25 minutes
LU4	16. KPI Dashboard Design	20 minutes
LU4	17. PR Campaign Audit Exercise	25 minutes

Assessment

- Written Assessment (WA) — Short-Answer Questions (SAQ), 1 hour, open book.
- Case Study (CS) — one continuous branding scenario with open-ended tasks, 1 hour, open book.
- Format: Open Book — this Learner Guide, the course slides and approved materials only.
- Grading: Competent / Not Yet Competent.
- A minimum of 75% attendance (per SSG Digital Attendance record) is required to be eligible for assessment and funding. Learners must be assessed as Competent and complete the TRAQOM survey.

Assessment Flow

1. TRAQOM — scan the TRAQOM QR code on the LMS and complete the survey.
2. Assessment Digital Attendance.
3. Assessment (Written Assessment + Case Study).
4. Submit the assessment answers on the LMS.
5. Sign the Assessment Summary Record.

Courseware and the assessment are on the LMS: <https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/>

Glossary

- **Brand positioning** — The distinct place a brand occupies in the customer's mind relative to competitors.
- **Stakeholder** — Any internal or external party with an interest in, or influence over, the brand.
- **Active listening** — Giving full attention, applying a structured framework, and paraphrasing without judgement.
- **Brand equity** — The commercial value derived from consumer perception of the brand, not the product itself.
- **KPI** — Key Performance Indicator — a specific, measurable metric used to judge progress against a goal.
- **AMEC framework** — An industry framework for measuring and evaluating PR / communication campaign effectiveness.
- **NPS** — Net Promoter Score — a customer-loyalty metric based on likelihood to recommend the brand.
- **TRAQOM** — The SSG post-course survey completed via the LMS, distinct from digital attendance.

Support

- Email: enquiry@tertiaryinfotech.com
- Tel: +65 6100 0613
- Website: www.tertiarycourses.com.sg
- LMS: <https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/>